Ian Hammerstrom

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Seattle, WA, USA
Updated resume: https://ihammerstrom.github.io/resume/

Overview

Senior/Lead Forward Deployed Engineer embedded on-site with customers, figuring out what they need, presenting approaches, and building/deploying solutions. Very full stack, from low-level **networking** daemons to cloud web apps, plus **computer security** (threat modeling, authn/authz) and **embedding LLMs** into products.

Skills

- Working directly with clients & presenting
- Explaining technical work to non-engineers
- Solution design & architecture review
- Project management
- Requirements scoping & prototyping
- 0 to 1 launches, and working in large preexisting products
- Debugging in offline client environments
- Direct-to-customer sales & fulfillment
- Mentoring engineers & hiring
- **Python, TypeScript/JavaScript/React, Java/Kotlin, C/C++, Bash, Go**
- Web & mobile: React Native, Django, Flask, Node
- Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Neo4j
- Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, Cloudflare, microservices
- Linux OS development & automation
- Backend APIs & integrations (REST, GraphQL)
- Networking: TCP/UDP, QUIC, DNS, TLS, HTTP(S)
- Security, threat modeling, authn/authz
- Integrating LLMs, ML and applied data science

Education

B.S. Computer Science (Data Science focus), Western Washington University - June 2016
ReactJS Quantum Degree, Next Academy - July 2019

Company	Roles
Orbis Operations 3/2025 - Present Seattle, WA (Remote) / Taiwan (on-site)	**Lead Engineer / Senior Forward Deployed Engineer (9/2025 - Present)** **Senior Forward Deployed Engineer (3/2025 - 9/2025)** • Pre-sales meetings with prospective clients alongside business development, showing how our technology could fit their systems. • 4 months on site in Taiwan with a client: understanding their goals and systems (hardware + software), creating a solution with our technology, and deploying/debugging it in sensitive/restricted environments, often without internet access. • Directly interfacing with and presenting to clients, scoping requirements, prototyping approaches, and seeing the work through. Project management and engineering strategy. • Networking & security engineering in defense intelligence. **TypeScript**, **Cloudflare**, JWTs, video streaming, raw socket programming, distributed auth, **GraphQL**.
2 Startups / Other Projects 6/2022 - 3/2025 Seattle, WA (Remote)	**Founder / Software Engineer – LocalPosters** • App converting event posters into calendar events via LLMs. Built with **Python Django, React Native, PostgreSQL**. Hired and managed a full-time engineer, launched iOS & Android. https://localposters.org **Founder / Software Engineer – EasySignal** • Financial recommendation subscription service (**Node.js, React.js, MongoDB**). Shut down due to low margins. Other: Learned C1 level of Spanish, DIY'd duplex into triplex, designed/built a backyard cabin.
Amazon 10/2020 - 6/2022 Seattle, WA (Remote)	**Software Engineer II** • Designed per-item Prime Badge data flow from Amazon.com to Buy With Prime checkout, used by merchants on their own sites (**Java/Kotlin, AWS ECS**). buywithprime.amazon.com • Built customer address integration used by millions of Prime members (GDPR/CCPA compliant). • Built **React** front-end metrics for checkout dashboards. Led Threat Model Assessments for other core teams.
Microsoft 3/2020 - 10/2020 Seattle, WA (Remote)	**Software Engineer** • Implemented multi-stage approvals for RBAC in Azure Privileged Identity Management (**C#/.NET**). https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-governance/create-access-review#create-a-multi-stage-access-review
Tableau Software 9/2019 - 3/2020 Seattle, WA (On-site)	**Software Engineer Contractor** • Built web app (**Python Django** + **React**) for running tests in **Docker on AWS**. • Built test-finding service using **Neo4j** dependency graphs for GitLab PRs. Reduced developers' test time from 2+ hrs to ~30s.
jcat.bike 3/2019 - 4/2022 Seattle, WA	**Founder / Software Engineer** • Founded a folding bicycle company while traveling overland from Scotland to Singapore (https://jcat.bike). Manufactured in Tianjin, China. • Built **Python Flask/React** web app with Stripe. Direct-to-customer sales, online and in person in Seattle, plus advertising and fulfillment.
F5 Networks 6/2016 - 6/2018 Seattle, WA (On-site)	**Software Engineer II (9/2017 - 6/2018)** • Networking microservices in **Golang** on **Docker/Kubernetes/AWS**. Duplicate address detection daemon in **Python**. Security Ninja: reviewed other teams' threat models. **Software Engineer I (9/2016 - 9/2017)** • **Python** daemon syncing config data to L3 routing daemons. **C** codebase bug fixes on custom Linux OS. **Software Engineer Intern (6/2016 - 9/2016)** • Built a transcompiler in **Python** to convert legacy routing configurations to modern format.